

QA INTERVIEW ACCELERATOR

Salary Negotiation Guide for QA

Negotiate your offer professionally and confidently.

Introduction

Most candidates accept the first number out of fear. A calm, professional negotiation can meaningfully increase your offer without risking it. This guide shows you how.

Instructions

- Research the market range for the role and location first.
- Let them name a number where possible.
- Negotiate on value, politely, once you have an offer.

Before You Negotiate

- Know the typical range (job sites, levels, your network).
- Decide your target and your walk-away minimum.
- Remember total package: salary, bonus, holiday, learning budget, flexibility.

Worked Example (response script)

"Thank you, I am really excited about this role. Based on my skills and the market for this position, I was hoping for something closer to [X]. Is there flexibility on the offer?" — said warmly, then pause and let them respond.

If They Cannot Move on Salary

- Ask about a review at 6 months tied to goals.
- Negotiate non-salary items (holiday, learning budget, remote days).
- Get any agreement in writing.

Practical Exercise

Research the range for a role you want, set your target and minimum, and write out your negotiation script in your own words.

Best Practices

- Stay warm and collaborative, never demanding.
- Anchor on value and market, not personal need.
- Be ready to justify your number briefly.

Common Mistakes

- Accepting instantly out of fear.
- Giving your number first with no research.
- Negotiating aggressively and souring the relationship.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Negotiating politely rarely loses an offer — employers expect it. The worst outcome is usually "we cannot move", which leaves you exactly where you started.